

Card 6: Help Ladder Trail

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · October 2026

Hackles Lab · Teacher card · Grades K-8 · [help-ladder-trail/index.html](https://competencecollective.org/help-ladder-trail/index.html)

Learning goal. Practice the routine in many situations, say the Tell sentence aloud, climb the Help Ladder (Next-Rung Rule), and learn that recovering from a slip is normal and shame-free.

SPECIMEN LABEL	
10 MIN	Mini Trail: 15 spaces, about 4 team turns, Gifty after every 2nd turn.
30 MIN	Full Trail: 40 spaces, about 9 team turns, Gifty after every 3rd. Teacher button Sunrise Wind lifts the Crew to 36.

A turn. Read the event twice. Teams whisper A, B or C. The active team moves the Crew: best 5, OK 4, Oops Path 3, never backward. Then the space acts: Ladder (Next-Rung Rule, earn a Rung Token), Helper, Breathe, or Gifty's stop (resist, then the coin). A hook is a Glitter Slip: the first is free, later ones go back 2, and a second pom-pom is a Sparkle Storm. A Rung Token cancels a Detour.

Tiers. Gold (no storms), Silver (one), Bronze (two or more). All win and cheer the same. The tier mostly shows the coin, so never praise or scold it. In 4,000 simulated games per mode, every Crew reached the Peak.

Voice. The teacher plays Gifty. If a child looks worried: "Gifty is a silly box with a hook."

Content. 20 K-5 events. E13 to E15 (stranger contact, secrecy), E22 and ladder card LA7 are left out on purpose. Gifty art is a placeholder.

Standards (approximate; verify). CSTA 1B-NI-05; ISTE 2b; CASEL Relationship Skills.

Accessibility. Ordered-list trail, letters and shapes on options, no timers or flashing. Spanish draft.

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